



Market Briefs Pro

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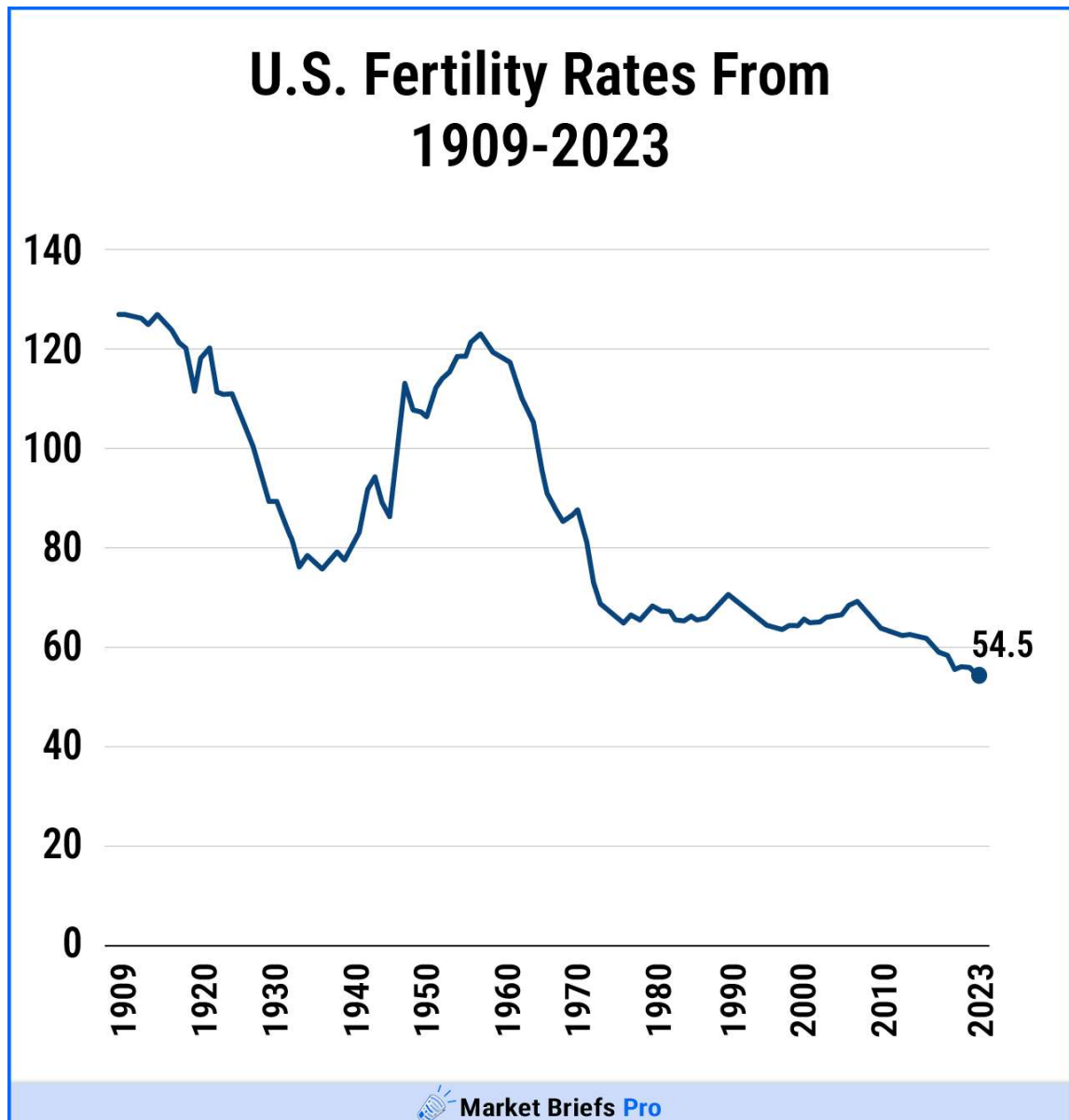
Hey, Pro Briefers!

People are having fewer kids - both in the U.S. and across the world.

And it's not just in 2025 - the U.S. has seen a decline in birth rates since the mid-1970s.

But over the last few years, this trend has accelerated. In 2007, there were over 2 births per 1,000 women.

Today, there are only 1.67 births per 1,000 women.

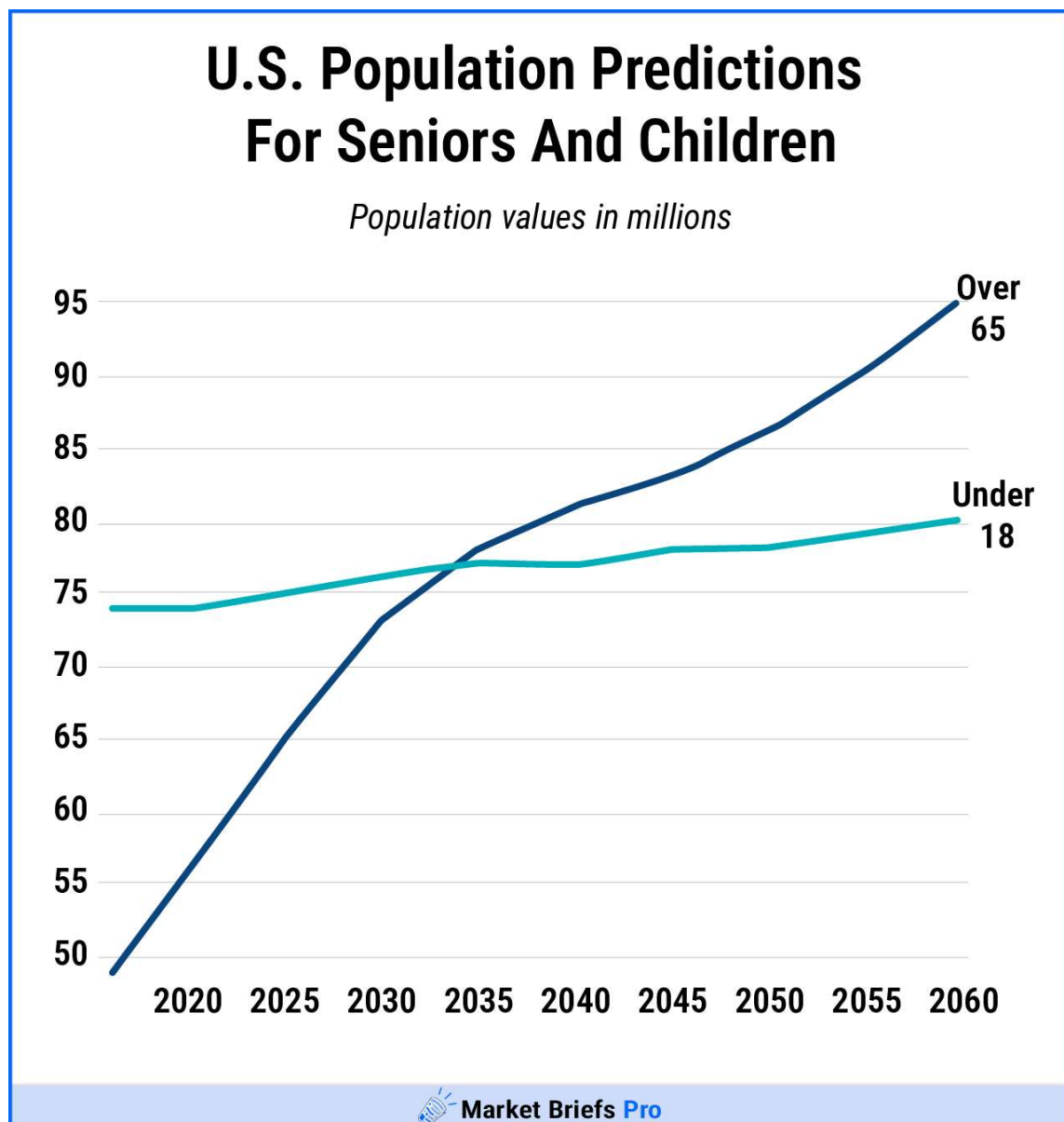


Why should investors care? Businesses and new legislation are aiming to increase birth rates in the U.S. - which is where we have identified a Government Shift:

Efforts to stimulate falling birthrates and care for aging populations in the U.S. could increase demand for fertility services, family planning, elder care, and childcare.

Let's break down why investors may want to keep an eye on this shift.

Here's what you need to know: Fewer children born can create some issues for an economy.



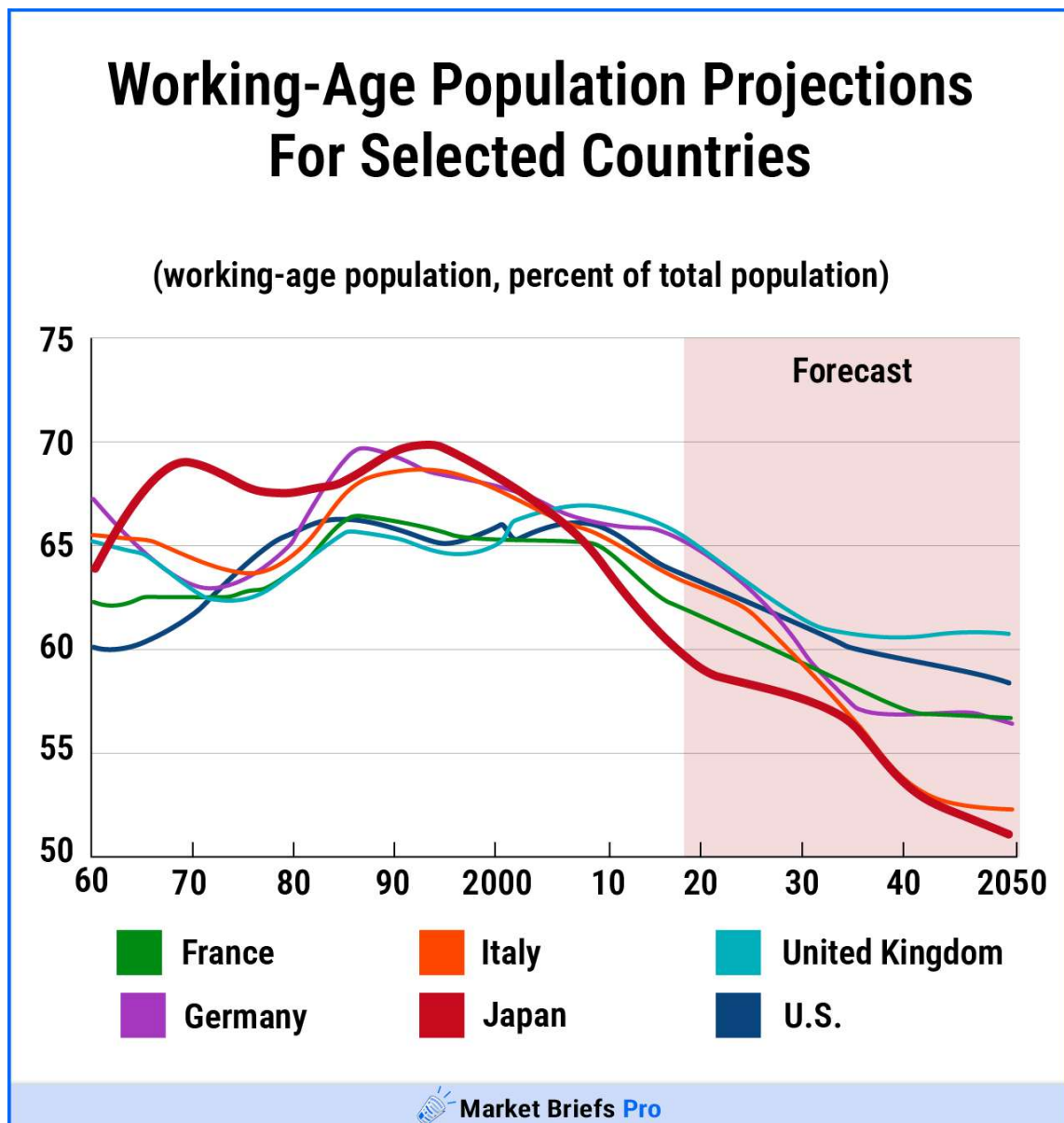
Data [via](#) USA Facts

For example, Japan has an aging population, meaning there are more old people than young.

- The average age in Japan is 48, 10 years older than the U.S.

Elder care is getting more expensive as a result - plus, there aren't enough young people to work and grow the economy.

Experts are worried the U.S. could go down the same path.



Data via IMF

In April 2025, the House of Representatives passed a bill hoping it will get people to have more kids.

- It includes a \$5,000 check, tax deductions, parental leave, and more.

In addition, President Trump announced a partnership in June 2025 with Dell (DELL) that would deposit \$1,000 into investment accounts for employees with newborns.

Dell will match the governments contribution, placing \$1,000 into an investment account for employees who just had a child.

- CEOs from Uber (UBER), Goldman Sachs (GS), and Robinhood (HOOD) supported the effort as well.

If these government incentives succeed, birth rates will begin to rise, leading to more spending on IVF services, childcare, and eventually elder care services.

To learn more about this, we spoke to Dr. Julia Cooney, a fertility and health longevity expert and also the CEO of the health startup Zest, in an exclusive interview.

For her, declining birth rates is an issue, but one the world is eager to solve,

"I think this is an interesting problem because on the one hand we have our declining birth rates and issues with supporting the aging population. On the other hand, you have people who are trying to cure aging and solve aging being told, 'Oh no, we'll have too many people on the world.'" - Dr. Cooney.

Here's how investors may be able to profit from these shifts in spending.

How did we do? Reply directly to this newsletter to let us know how you took action with this shift!

FAMILY PLANNING

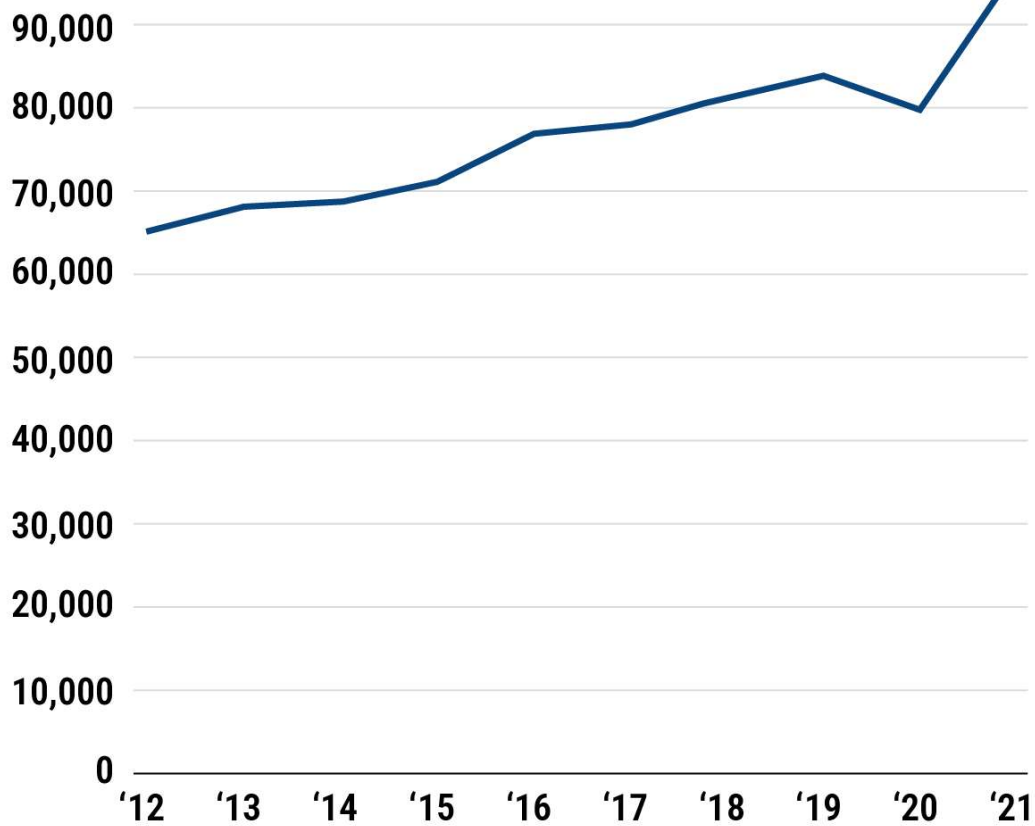
Future Families

If more people do decide to have kids, IVF may be able to help.

IVF = in vitro fertilization. It's a lab-assisted path for pregnancy.

In 2023, nearly 3% of all babies born in the U.S. were born through IVF, an increase from roughly 2% in 2022.

U.S. Babies Born With The Help Of IVF



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Data [via](#) USA facts

Over the last 30 years, IVF usage has increased by 150% percent in the U.S. as well, according to the National Institute of Health.

Why? The American Society of Reproductive Health showed 1 out of 6 women are unable to have kids due to genetic or other health issues.

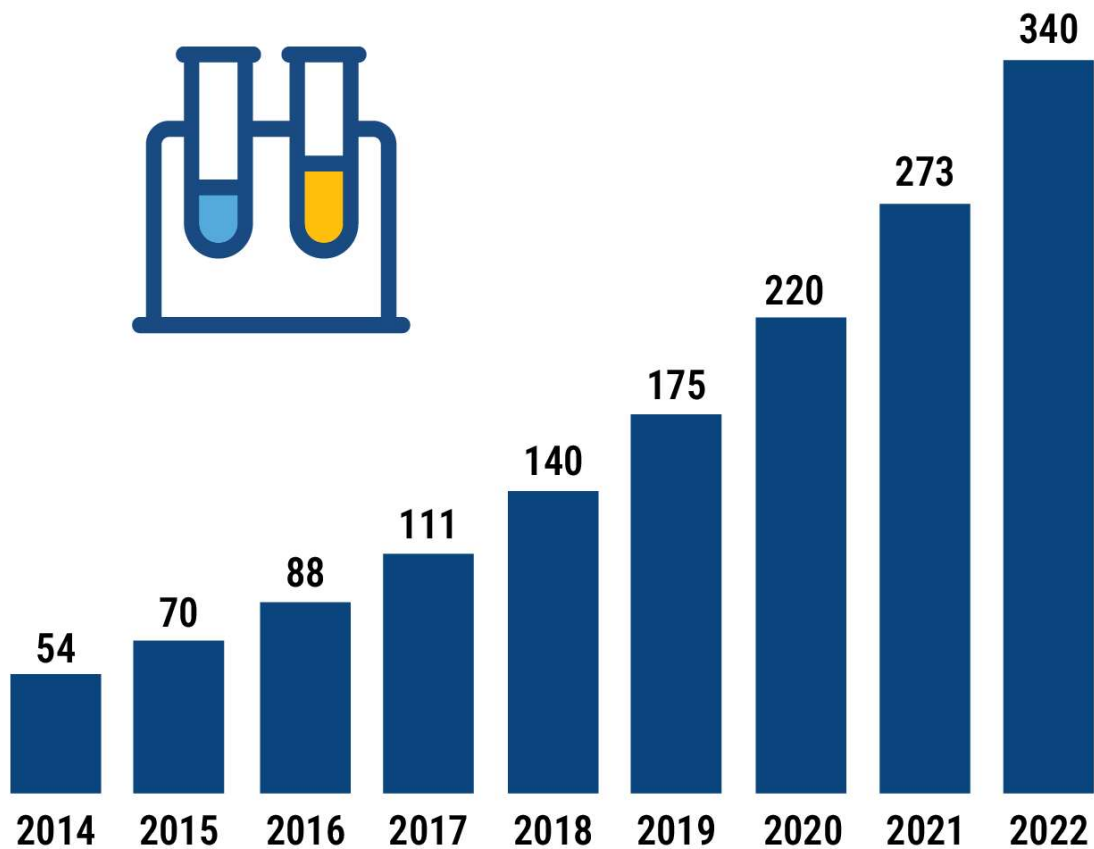
"95% of couples are conceiving sort of either naturally or with some other support, but not IVF. 14% need some sort of help with conception. So while it is massively growing, I wouldn't say it's going to become the norm anytime soon." - Dr. Cooney.

- In 2024, there were three bills proposed by Congress to help increase access to IVF treatments to women - all three are currently under review by committees.

In February 2025, President Trump signed an executive order to reduce the costs of IVF services and expand access.

Consumer Genetic Testing Growth Over Time

(In millions of U.S. dollars)



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Data [via](#) Statista

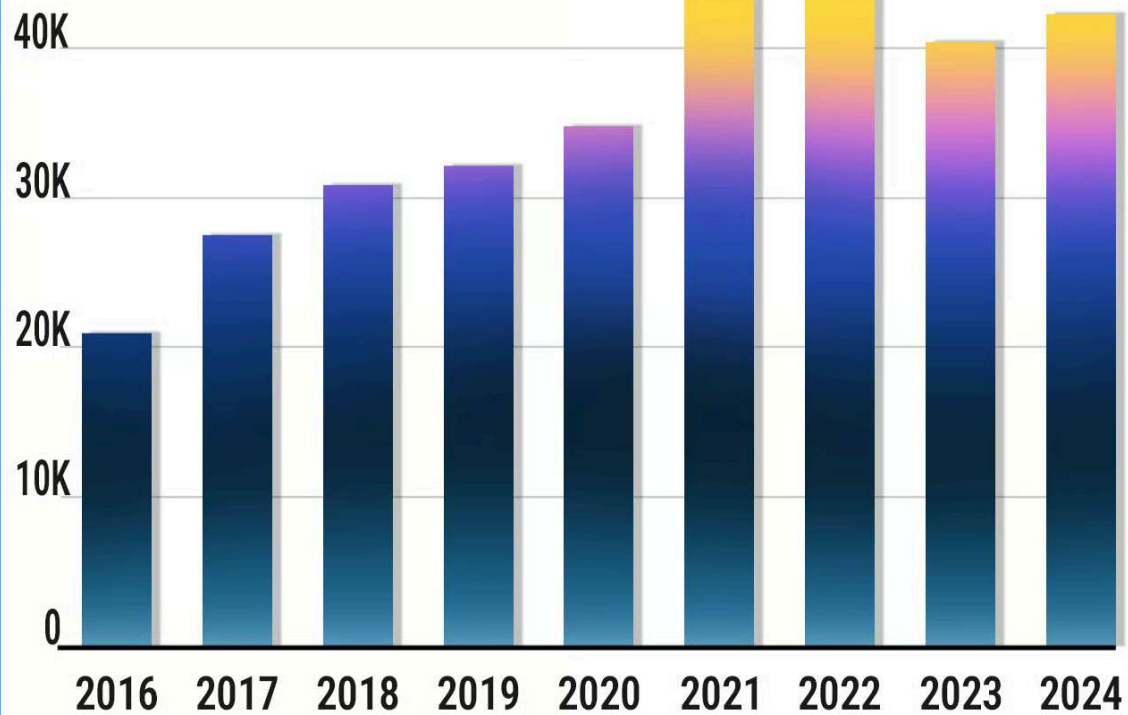
One of those IVF companies is Abbott Laboratories (ABT). While Abbott does not directly offer IVF treatments, its tech is crucial in the IVF process.

How? Abbott designs testing tools that scan embryos before fertilization. It can detect issues before patients spend the time and money going through IVF.

It also helps personalize reproductive care through its diagnostics division.

ABBOTT Laboratories (ABT)

(Revenues In \$Millions)



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Data [via](#) company reports

It pinpoints certain genetic factors, like hair and eye color, and helps patients to predict what their future children may look like.

- Its diagnostics division reported \$9.34 billion in revenue in 2024, a 6% increase from 2023.

And overall, Abbott's revenue jumped to over \$41 billion in 2024, up from \$40 billion the year prior.

As demand for IVF grows, Abbott's demand should as well.

Abbott Laboratories (ABT)

132.96
(+50.66%)

5 Year Price →



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Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

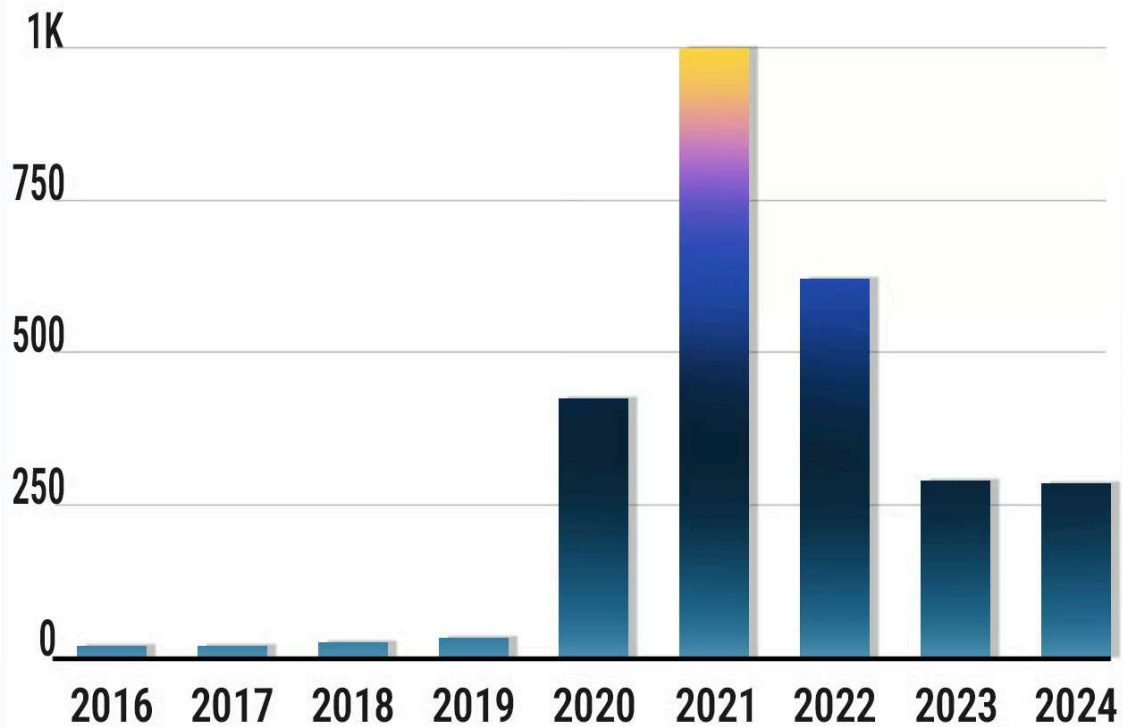
Another major player in the IVF space is Fulgent Genetics (FLGT).

Fulgent has technology that checks for hereditary information in our cells.

Fulgent Genetics, Inc.

(A)

(Revenues In \$Millions)



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Data [via](#) company reports

- **What does this mean?** Fulgent can tell you things like which side of the family is responsible for your hair loss.

It now partners with around 230 fertility clinics in the U.S., a 15% year-over-year increase from 2023.

Fulgent Genetics, Inc. (FLGT)

21.29
(+26.05%)

5 Year Price →



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Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

The company also had \$285 million in revenue in 2024 and projects that it will make over \$300 million in revenue by the end of this year.

What else? Investors can also find opportunities in fertility within the Global X Health & Wellness ETF (BFIT).

Global X Health & Wellness ETF (BFIT)

4 Year Price →

21.39
(+13.18%)



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Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

CHILDCARE

Toddler Economy

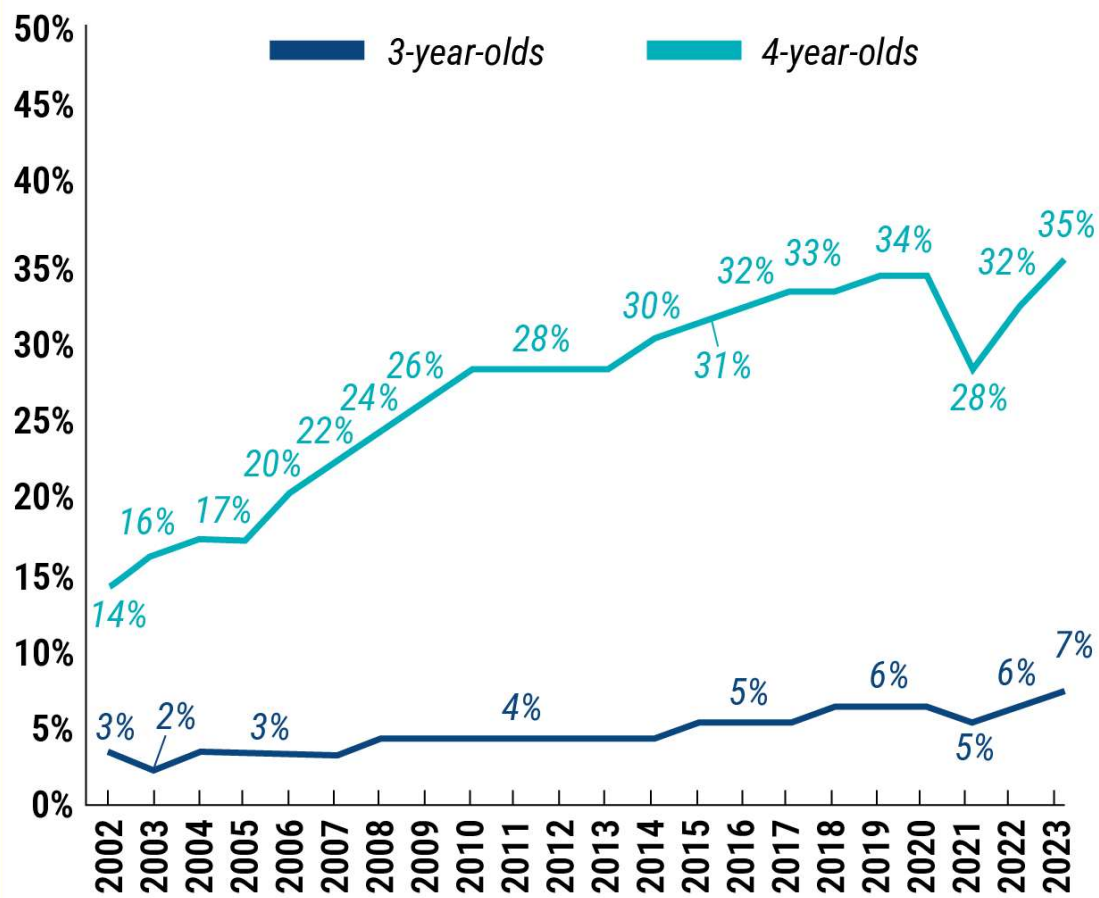
As of 2023, nearly 66% of parents who have children under five use childcare.

Why? *Work from home is mostly over* - 66% of moms and dads work in-office more, at least three days a week.

And while work from home is unlikely to go away completely, more than half of U.S. businesses are back in the office full-time again.

The point: If government incentives mean more adults have kids, someone will need to take care of them while parents are working.

Percentage Of U.S. Population Enrolled In Preschool



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Data via NIEER

Dr. Cooney also stressed the need for daycare as birth rates rise during our exclusive interview,

"If governments are serious about raising birth rates then daycare infrastructure really does have to follow that. I think the biggest factor is still the cost of living associated with sort of raising a child and a family. And so supporting the daycare side of things is definitely a no-brainer."

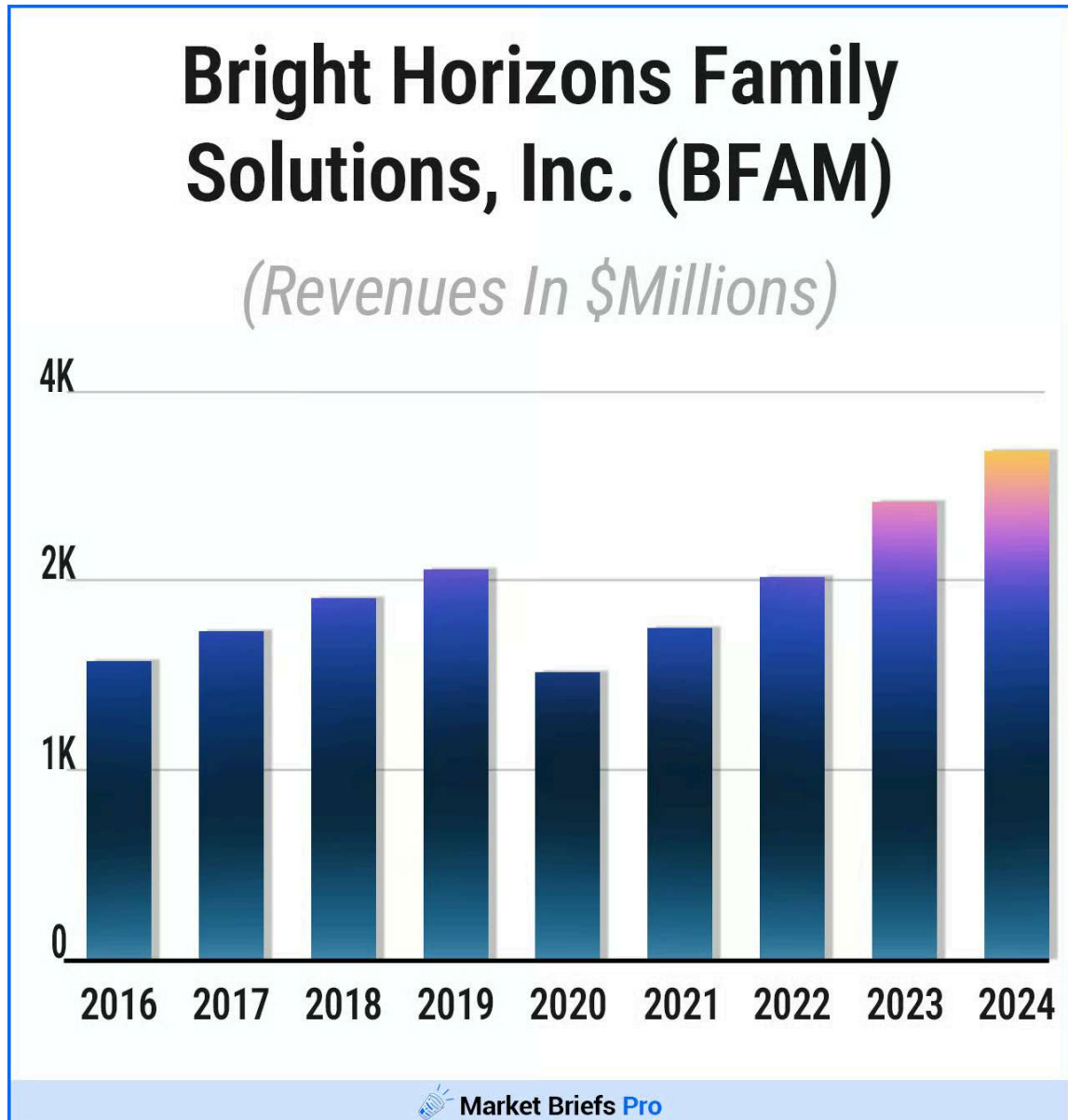
Daycare and childcare have been growing in demand and may continue to grow if more adults have children.

And, parents who enroll their child in daycare can deduct some of those costs off their taxes, which helps them save money.

- The average cost of childcare in the U.S. is around \$1,000 per month as of 2024, according to Care.com.

The largest publicly traded daycare company in the U.S. is Bright Horizons Family Solutions (BFAM), and will benefit as this shift develops.

What do they do? The company provides full-time childcare services, education, and back-up care services to parents.



Data [via](#) company reports

It also has a global presence - Bright Horizons operates well over 1,000 centers in places like Australia, the U.K., India, and the U.S.

But a significant portion of its revenue is from corporate partnerships.

Out of all Fortune 500 companies, 220 partner with Bright Horizons for childcare services.

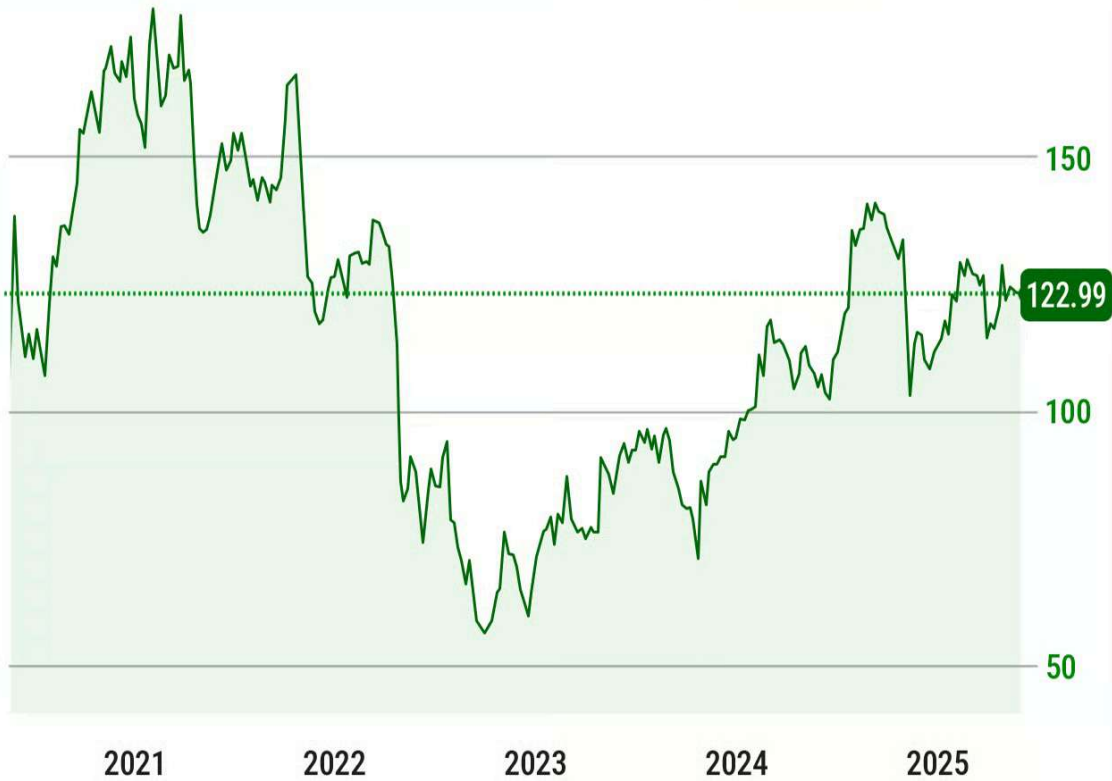
What does that mean? You work for one of those companies, you get exclusive access to their childcare built into your employment.

- Last year, these partnerships accounted for 74% of Bright Horizons \$2.4 billion in revenue.

Bright Horizons Family Solutions Inc. (BFAM)

122.99
(+16%)

5 Year Price →



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Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

Daycare not only takes care of the physical needs of children, but their educational needs, too.

That's part of the reason why there's a booming demand for more educational toys in the U.S.

Mattel (MAT) is one of the most iconic names in kids toys and has been shifting more of its business strategy towards educational toys in recent years.

It does this mainly through its Fisher-Price brand, a leading educational toy brand.

Mattel, Inc. (MAT)

19.32
(+130.55%)

5 Year Price →



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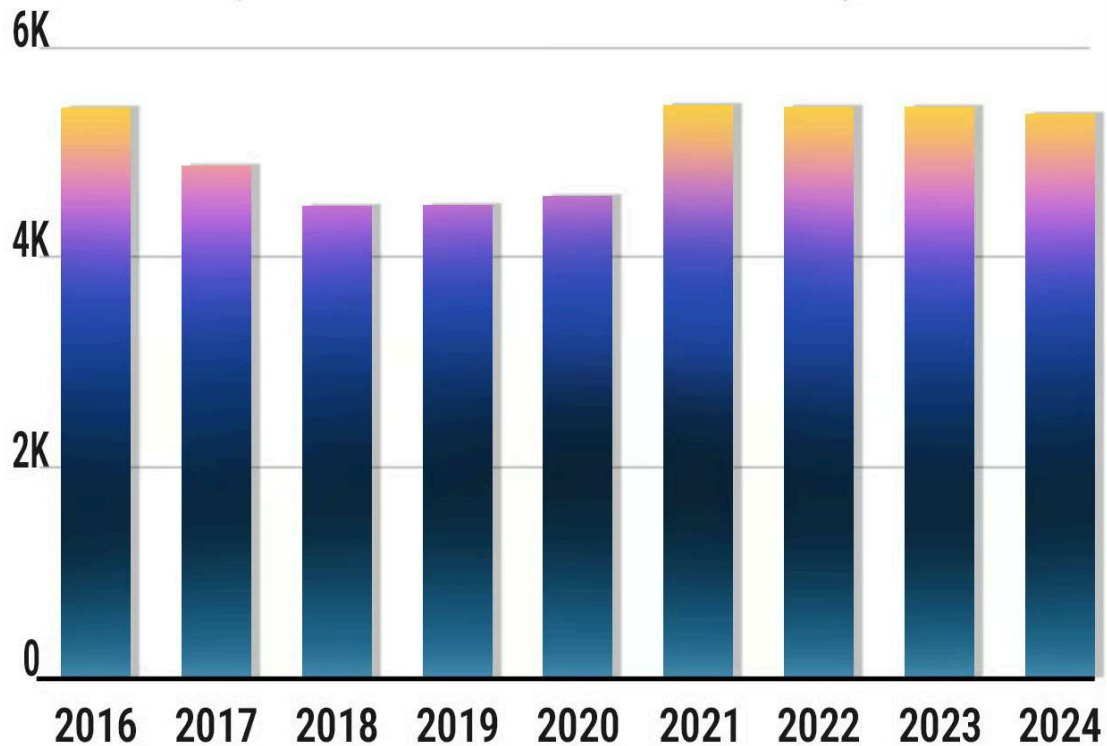
Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

Why does this matter? Global toy sales in general are falling - Mattel only saw its overall revenue increase by 0.12% in 2024.

- Its net income (total revenue minus expenses) also fell, along with its earnings per share.

Mattel, Inc. (MAT)

(Revenues In \$Millions)



 Market Briefs Pro

Data [via](#) company reports

But, Fisher-Price actually saw a 7% increase in sales, further proving that educational toys are in and toys just for entertainment are losing ground.

ELDER CARE

The Silver Shift

The University of Michigan is predicting that by the year 2,100, Americans on average will live to be around 88 years old.

- That's up from 77 years old in 2022.

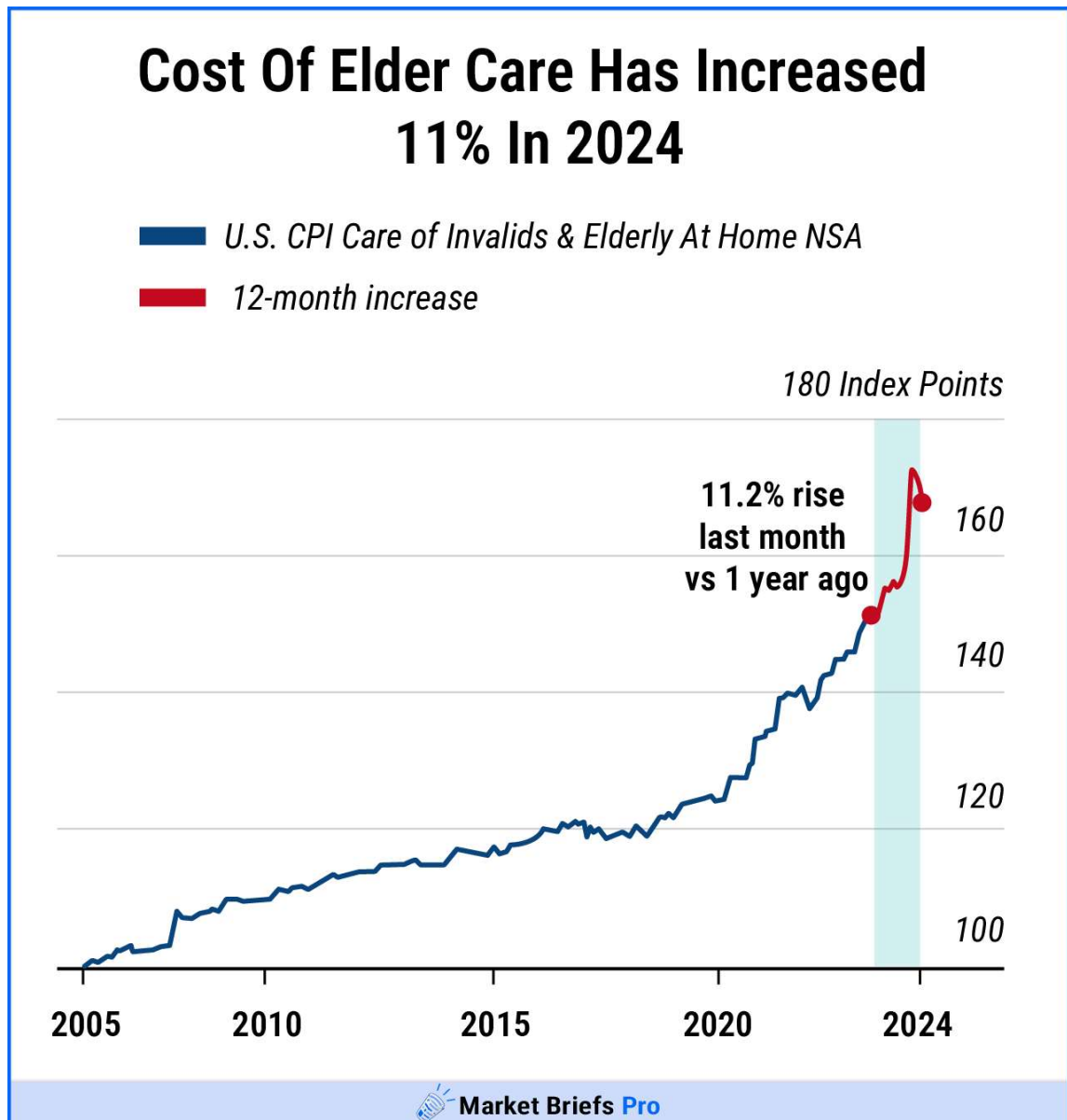
Government incentives may make more people have kids.

But what happens when our population grows and gets older?

More Americans being born + more people living longer = increased costs to take care of them.

That is leading to increased investment from the federal government and businesses into services that help take care of the elderly.

"In 100 years, we've doubled our lifespans as humans, but we haven't really changed our health spans. What's going to help that is preventative health care, early testing, early intervention, but the other half of that is definitely biotech." - Dr. Cooney.



Data via Bloomberg

A bill passed by Congress in 2024 increased federal spending by 20% to \$2.76 billion on services like meals, transportation, caregiver assistance, and elder rights protections.

But overall, services that cater to the elderly will naturally see a rise in demand as more people are born and age.

Brookdale Senior Living (BKD) is a leading operator of senior living communities in the U.S., and is already seeing a boost in demand as the U.S. population gets older.

For Brookdale, it's all about occupancy - the more rooms it fills, the more money it makes.



Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

In 2023, it collected \$2.85 billion in fees from residents, a 10.5% year-over-year increase.

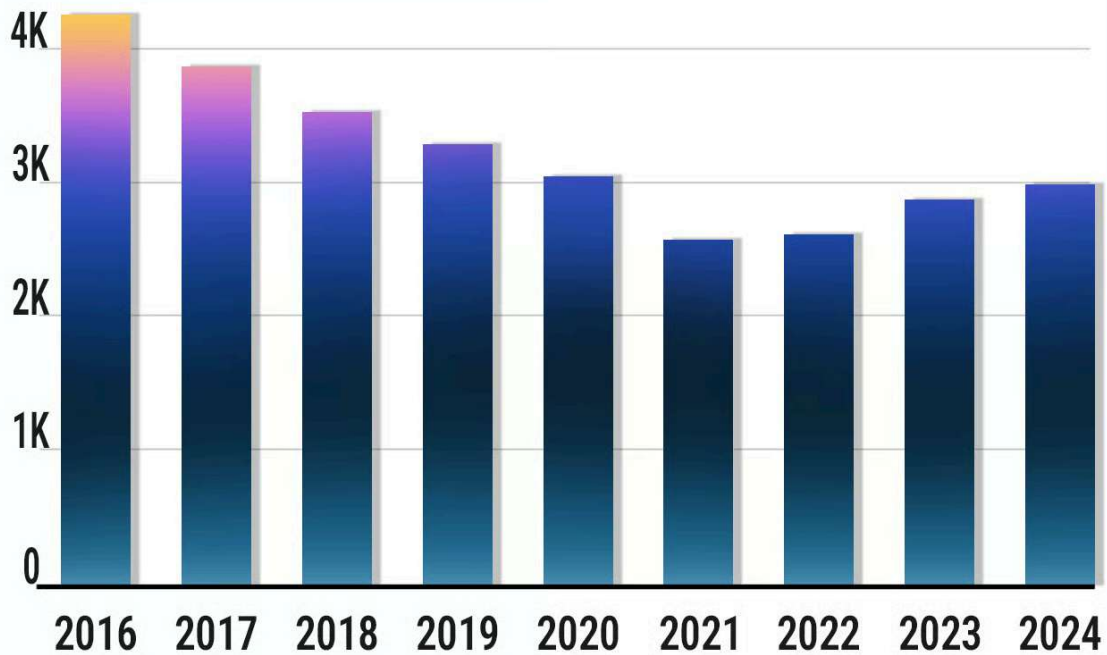
This was mostly due to a large number of new residents entering its communities throughout the U.S.

And while Brookdale has operated at a loss over the past few years, that loss is shrinking as it focuses on operational efficiency.

- Its EBITDA (earnings before interest, taxes, depreciation, and amortization) jumped by 39%, meaning it generated cashflow from its operations.

Brookdale Senior Living, Inc. (BKD)

(Revenues In \$Millions)



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Data [via](#) company reports

On the flipside, healthcare services are going to see a huge jump in demand as our population ages.

As a result, preventative screening and testing for diseases will be important for retirees.

Quest Diagnostics (DGX) is a nationwide leader in health testing - they do things like brain scans, blood tests, and more.

What makes them stand out is speed. Patients can get blood tests and X-rays in minutes, without having to go to a hospital or schedule an appointment.

Quest Diagnostics Incorporated (DGX)

5 Year Price →

170.48
(+50.88%)



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Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

It's also a leader in Alzheimer's and dementia testing, which are diseases that mainly impact those over 65.

- Last year, the company earned \$9.87 billion in revenue, up from \$9.25 billion in 2023.

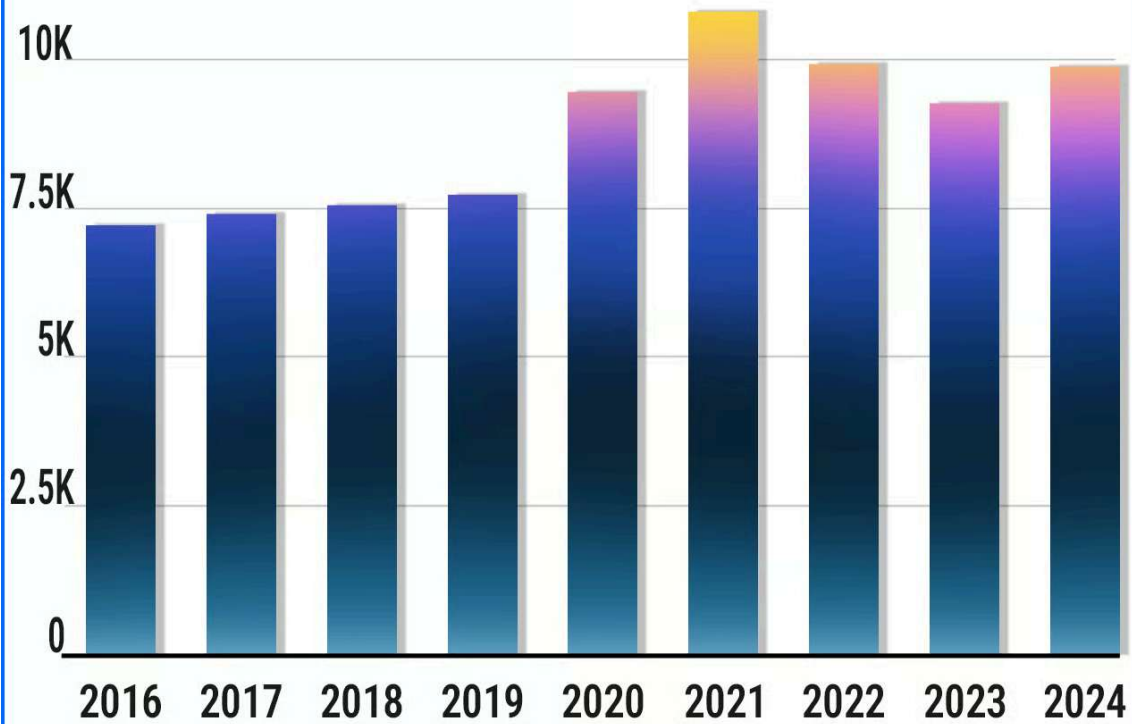
Quest is also making some big acquisitions as demand rises.

In 2024, the company bought 8 health companies, the most acquisitions it has made in a single year.

Lastly, Quest has increased its dividend for 14 consecutive years, returning its steady profits back to investors.

Quest Diagnostics Incorporated (DGX)

(Revenues In \$Millions)



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Data via company reports

RISKS

Growing Pains

The population growing could mean new opportunities, but there are some potential risks to this shift.

Right now, the Trump administration and Congress are focused on providing incentives to increase birth rates.

These government initiatives could change, or not be approved.

- Also, there's no guarantee that these incentives will work.

Finally, fertility companies and service providers to children or the elderly often take on annual losses, rather than profits.

This is because these industries have lots of regulations and other costs associated with them, making it difficult to consistently keep net income in the green.

Some businesses are able to, but investors should be aware that losses in the fertilization, childcare, and elder care industries are not uncommon and could cause volatility in share prices over time.

Dr. Cooney also mentioned costs as an issue during our discussion,

"Cost is probably the biggest [barrier] at the moment. Also practically things like time off work especially for women. Obviously government subsidies are going to go a long way towards that."

REVIEW

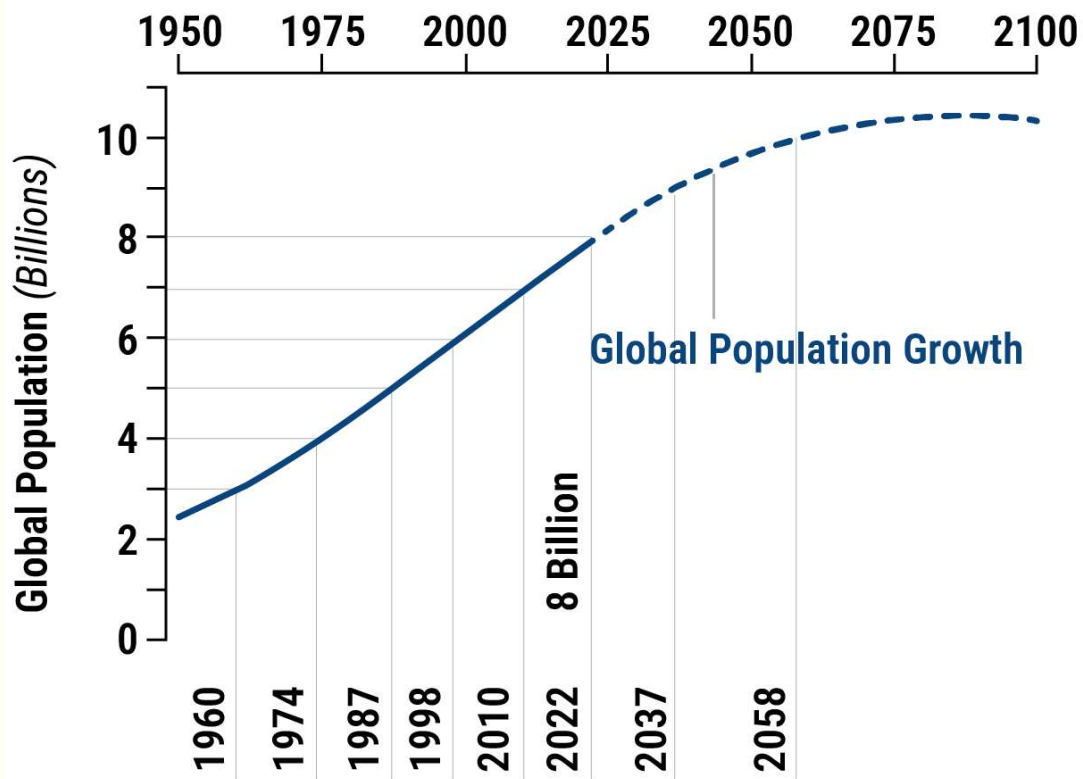
What Comes Next

Birth rates are falling in the U.S. - but, efforts from the federal government are being made to increase them, and take care of our aging population of retirees.

- If these incentives are passed, more Americans will have kids, leading to a higher demand for IVF services, childcare, and eldercare.

Because right now, projections show that America's population is getting older and there are fewer young workers to sustain the economy.

Global Population Growth



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Data via Scientific American

That's creating opportunities for businesses that focus on childcare, elder care, fertility, and family planning.

"There's a lot of opportunity to move beyond just IVF and look at that whole process, that sort of preconception, postconception. I'm actually quite optimistic that we do have the tools to solve this and to sort of optimize where the population is." - Dr. Cooney.

No one knows if it will spark a baby boom, but investors will still want to keep an eye on this shift for the long term.



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